현대 응용 영어

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UNIT 1	3/12
Subject	Introduce yourself

Good afternoon.

The subject of unit 1 is Introduce yourself.

So, I'd like to introduce myself. My name is 이은정, and I am currently majoring in Computer Science and Engineering. I have a passion for problem-solving and enjoy using computer programming for creating entertaining contents. Since elementary school, I have been fascinated by software and coding. That led me to pursue this field of study.

In classes with my professors, they always mention the prominence of the United States in the global software industry. A hub of technological innovation in US like Silicon Valley boasts the presence of renowned companies such as Apple and Netflix. It's fascinating to note that many groundbreaking advancements in both software and hardware have originated from the US, with notable examples including the invention of the transistor. The unique working culture and environment prevalent in the US tech industry serve as a constant source of studying for me.

For working in the IT industry, I believe the most important thing is keeping up with the latest tech trends. It's crucial to study in line with these trends and seek job opportunities accordingly. That's why I consider the United States to be one of the most appealing places for me. Even though I've never traveled abroad, I dream of moving to the US one day and establishing a career there. I know that for making this dream come true, I need for improving my English-speaking skills to a proficient level. That's why I'm doing my best in this Intermediate Modern English class.

UNIT 1	3/13
Subject	What do you enjoy doing in your free time?

I have a huge love for art, and I find great joy in engaging in various artistic activities during my leisure time. The object of unit 1 is what do you enjoy doing in your free time? So, I categorized my hobbies into three types, and I want for sharing my hobbies with you.

Firstly, let me introduce my casual hobbies. One of my favorite hobbies is listening to music. I have a broad appreciation for different genres, but I am particularly drawn to new age, classical music, and traditional folk. I have a special interest for classical instrumental music. Because they evoke deep emotions within me when I'm listening to them. Recently, I've also developed an interest in opera, and I often dedicate moments of my spare time to discovering and immersing myself in its beautiful melodies.

Moving on to my project-based hobby, I have a deep passion for playing musical instruments, especially the violin and piano. Playing these instruments brings me immense joy and serves as a means of relaxation, especially when I have stressful times. I often find relaxion in playing the piano in my dormitory after doing challenging assignments.

Lastly, let me share with you my serious hobby. Composing music has been a significant part of my life since I was ten years old. I've been composing simple piano melodies, and to further hone my skills, I joined an orchestra. Seeing how every instrument adds its own sound for making beautiful music has made me even more passionate about it. Lately, I've started learning how to mix vocals with instruments music. I'm really excited for getting better at it.

UNIT 2	3/19
Subject	What do you watch on TV or online?

Since the semester began, my schedule has become increasingly busy, leaving me with little time for leisure activities such as watching TV or browsing online. With numerous assignments to complete, I could find myself studying late into the night.

As a result, I've turned to social media platforms like YouTube for entertainment during short breaks. Given my limited free time, I've found that short videos are more suitable than full-length movies or dramas.

The biggest benefit of social media's short video is the convenience of being able to watch these videos on my phone while on the go. Short videos are highly accessible and can be easily melted into busy daily routines. When it's during a short break between study sessions, I can watch these videos conveniently on-the-go using smartphones or other portable devices. This benefit makes them an ideal choice for me.

Furthermore, the diverse range of content available in short video format caters to various interests and preferences. There is every content such as educational tutorials, entertaining sketches, or informative documentaries that I'm interested in. It often delivers quick bursts of information or entertainment, making me to learn new concepts or stay updated on current trends efficiently. This is particularly beneficial for me as I have limited time but want to get educational or informative contents.

Thanks to this benefit, it is always helping me to get new information.

UNIT 2	3/20
Subject	How do you show politeness and formality in your languages or culture?

The topic of Unit 2 is the demonstration of politeness and formality in language and culture. So, I searched some ways for showing politeness. These are examples.

Firstly, the use of specific words that present respect for the partner is a fundamental aspect of politeness. Additionally, gestures such as bowing the back when greeting adults signify respect and acknowledgment of their seniority.

And when people eat together within larger family gatherings, it is customary for children to wait patiently and refrain from eating until the oldest adult starts their meal. This practice reflects reverence for elders and emphasizes the importance of hierarchical relationships within the family unit.

Moreover, when receiving a drink poured by an older individual, it is customary to accept it with both hands as a gesture of gratitude and respect. Conversely, when offering a drink to an elder, it is customary to conceal the label of the bottle and hold the bottle's neck with the left hand while supporting the body of the bottle with the right hand.

Additionally, in situations when younger individuals drink alcohol in the presence of adults, it is polite to avoid direct face-to-face contact by turning the head slightly to the left or right.

Overall, these examples present the various cultural norms and customs for demonstrating politeness and formality within interpersonal interactions. The common ground of these customs highlights the importance of respecting social hierarchies and expressing gratitude towards others.

UNIT 3	3/26
Subject	What public art is near you?

The object of unit 3 is what public art is near you. So, I'd like to talk about art while we're on the subject of public art near me.

For the first, I will share about the public art. The public art encompasses anything that is aesthetic and easily enjoyed. In Suwon, my hometown, we have the "Suwon Hwaseong" castle, a renowned landmark. The government frequently hosts festivals there for preserving its historical value by offering visitors opportunities for immersing themselves in traditional culture, music, and performances. Next to the wall of castle, there are a lot of murals depicting aspects of traditional Joseon lifestyle. I view all of these as forms of public art. While I don't regularly visit art museums, I do make an effort for going at least once a year.

As for my personal artistic interests, I am passionate about various creative expressions. I find joy in drawing, listening to music, playing instruments, and attending orchestral and opera performances. Additionally, I have a deep appreciation for reading novels.

Reflecting on the diversity of art, I am struck by the multitude of forms it can take, from video and drawing to poetry, novels, and music. Each medium offers distinct avenues for exploration and appreciation, with music standing out as my favorite.

In terms of favorite artists, Herman Hesse holds a special place in Western art for me. I consider his books to be masterpieces, especially for their intricate narratives about life, adolescence, and love. Whenever I feel I've matured since my last reading, I revisit his works during my leisure time to uncover new layers of meaning.

Finally, the significance of art in society cannot be overstated. It serves as a crucial means of expression, community-building, and stress relief. Moreover, research has shown a link between engagement with art and a decrease in crime rates, underscoring its pivotal role in fostering social well-being.

UNIT 4	3/27
Subject	Describe your best friend

The topic of unit 4 is describing my best friend, so I'd like to introduce my best friend, "김민지". She's someone who enjoys engaging in discussions and critical thinking. Currently, she's majoring in social sciences at 아주 University in Suwon. I first met her when we were in elementary school, and we've known each other for a very long time. Though I can't recall the exact sequence of events. But over time, we naturally grew closer and eventually became best friends. There wasn't any particular standout moment that brought us together, but I believe that the accumulation of shared experiences and everyday interactions played a significant role in strengthening our bond.

We often spend our time together discussing various topics, including our future aspirations, shared interests, societal issues, and sharing jokes. While these topics may seem common, they have helped me gain a deeper understanding of her perspective and personality. As we continued to grow closer, we found ourselves confiding in each other more and more. And now, she's my closest friend.

We frequently talk about our experiences at university and any special events that come up. Additionally, we enjoy hanging out together whenever we have free time. One thing that I truly appreciate about her is the emotional support she provides me with during both good and challenging times. Even though we attend different universities, we share our experiences and support each other. When we need each other’s opinions, we do our best to help each other. We are in different places, but we find happiness in each other’s presence.

UNIT 5	4/2
Subject	Interest and Attitude towards Technology and Digital Devices

We talked about Interest and Attitude towards Technology and Digital Devices in unit 5. So, during our class, I find some answers at that class. These are my perspectives on several key questions.

The first question is if you get excited by new technology. The answer is absolutely yes. As a Computer Science major, it's crucial to stay follow new software technologies for several reasons. Because the IT industry is constantly evolving. Currently, the new technology about AI such as deep learning is rapidly developing. The knowledge of these trends enhances competitiveness in the job market, as employers seek candidates proficient in cutting-edge technologies. And I think in individual perspective, exploring new technologies can help excitement and motivation, driving personal and professional growth in the field.

In discussing the pace of technological development, I confirmed the accelerating cycles of the industrial revolution. As industries experience increasingly rapid changes, it becomes imperative to keep pace with these advancements to remain in the IT society. My professor highlights the importance, and he emphasized the need for continuous learning and adaptation for navigation of the ever-evolving technological landscape.

Regarding the approach to new products, I rarely consult instruction manuals. Instead, I rely on my intuition and utilize online resources when facing challenges. With the abundance of information available on the internet, I find that it often proves more helpful, especially in navigating unexpected or exceptional situations.

In terms of online activity, I spend a significant amount of time. It often exceeds 40 hours per week, due to the demands of my major. While I recognize this as excessive. But I have to use internet for studying. So, I try to spend time for productive online activities such as coding for assignments and troubleshooting bugs, not browsing social media or entertainment contents.

In summary, following new technologies currently affects all of my life including my major, and lifestyle. I know the importance of IT trends. So, I always do my best for following social changes.

UNIT 6	4/9
Subject	Party

We discussed parties in Unit 6, and I'd like to delve deeper into the topic.

When it comes to attending parties, I'm not particularly fond of crowded places. However, as an executive member of my department group, attending parties for official major events is a responsibility I cannot avoid. Therefore, I typically find myself at parties only when they are held for such occasions.

In that parties, as for my preferences at parties, I attend with the intention of meeting new people and making friends. I enjoy engaging in conversations over meals and drinks, relishing the opportunity to interact with unfamiliar faces and exchange stories.

Regarding the venue for parties, most of the parties I've attended have been hosted at restaurants. But as I told before, I don't prefer crowed places like pub or restaurant. However, I harbor a preference for hosting parties in the comfort of my own home. When the decision to host a party is made, I ensure my home is clean and extend invitations to my closest friends. Upon their arrival, we collectively decide on the menu, often ordering food online with our preferences changing each time. While awaiting the delivery of our chosen dishes, we always have conversations, often reminding about events from our middle school years. Though the topic remains constant, the atmosphere is consistently bright.

Once the food arrives, we indulge in a delightful dinner accompanied by refreshing beverages. It's during these moments that we share our most profound worries and concerns. We discuss for finding the way to solve our worries. It fosters an environment of real friendship. Eventually, as the night progresses, we go to sleep, concluding yet another memorable home party filled with laughter, good food, and cherished friendships.

This is a kind of plain home party I most prefer.

UNIT 6	4/9
Subject	Where did you last go on vacation?

During my vacation, I typically spent my weekdays from Monday to Thursday in the laboratory. And I also spent weekends for part-time work. Consequently, I rarely had the opportunity for travelling. So, for the object of unit 6, 'where did you last go on vacation', I will share my one-day travel experience.

It all began on the final weekend before the starting of the new semester, when our laboratory's professor made an unexpected announcement. He said, "If you wish to dedicate time to prepare for the upcoming semester, you are excused from laboratory duties this week." Despite having a lot of tasks for submitting, I made a spontaneous decision to embark on a one-day journey.

Several weeks prior to this, a new, expansive department store named Star Field had opened its doors next to Suwon Station. I had longed to visit this renowned establishment, as I had heard remarkable tales of its huge size and numerous entertainment offerings. Moreover, I was excited in the fact that Star Field welcomed pet owners, allowing them to bring their beloved pets along. So, I invited a friend to accompany me, to which he readily agreed.

Early the next morning, we set out on our excursion. True to its reputation, Star Field boasted an array of amenities. From a rooftop park designed for every pet to vast shopping areas reminiscent of Costco, the department store did not disappoint. We fell in love in delectable snacks and explored the various cafés and restaurants renowned for their signature dishes. And I think the donuts I sampled were delicious any I had ever tasted before.

While some may consider a department store an unsuitable choice for a travel destination, I found immense pleasure in exploring its grandeur. Indeed, the experience felt akin to embarking on a journey of discovery. It was a remarkable and unforgettable experience. So, If I have enough time next vacation, I hope to visit there again.